

	AREA	SRO	Special Rules of Order	
	POLICY	004	Method for Executive Deliberation & Informal Discussion	
	OWNERS	Executive Committee		
	AFFECTS	Executive Committee		
INTRODUCED		12/05/2026	REVIEWED	N/A
AMENDMENT HISTORY		N/A		

[SRO-004] | Standards for Non-Actionable Informal Discussion

PURPOSE & SCOPE

1. The UTSU Executive Committee, as defined in Article 7 of the bylaws, is responsible for the day to day operation and strategic direction of the UTSU. This policy establishes a standardized structured “Informal Discussion” procedure to allow for the committee to engage in collaborative discussion and information sharing without the constraints of a set action item or vote.
2. This policy is to ensure that members of the committee can present “Points of Information” regarding their specific portfolios or initiatives in a conversational format.
3. To apply strictly to meetings of the Executive Committee.

POLICY

4. Any member of the Executive Committee may move to enter into a period of Informal Discussion regarding a specific topic.
5. While in informal discussion, the committee cannot pass binding executive orders, authorize expenditures or vote.
6. The formal rules of debate are suspended. The chair shall be responsible for ensuring balanced dialogue between all members of the committee.
7. The informal period will have no set time limit but is governed by the scope of the “Whereas” clauses.
8. If the informal discussion involves sensitive personnel or legal matters, the committee is must and is able to move to go In Camera.
9. The informal period shall conclude upon any of the following three conditions:
 - a. The introduction of a formal, actional motion on the subject.
 - b. A majority vote of the committee to end the informal session.
 - c. The chair moves the committee to the next item on the agenda.

PROCEDURE

10. The following steps must be followed for an Informal Discussion item to be valid:

- a. The moving committee member must submit the motion by the agenda deadline
- b. The item must follow the following template:
 - i. Motion for Informal Discussion regarding [Topic]

WHEREAS [Background information or problem]; and
WHEREAS [Stated reason for informal discussion];

BE IT RESOLVED that the Executive Committee enters informal discussion with said informal period concluding upon the introduction of a formal motion for action, a majority vote to return to regular order, or at the discretion of the Chair.

11. Once the motion is adopted, the chair will be responsible for managing the floor and ensuring that the focus remains on the topic of the motion.

12. The informal period shall end upon the following:

- a. A member states: "I move that [Actionable Motion]." Upon a second, the chair will announce that the informal period is closed.
- b. A member moves to return to regular order. This requires a second and a majority vote.
- c. If the chair determines the discussion has reached its natural conclusion or time constraints require progress, the chair has the prerogative to state: "The informal period is closed; we are moving onto item [X] on the agenda."